



PAPUA NEW GUINEA

POLESTAR INSIGHTS

REPORTING PERIOD: 10 JULY 2026 - 16 JULY 2026

POLESTAR-ADVISORY.COM

BOTTOM LINE UP FRONT

The assessment centres on crime, theft and violent incidents, policing and regulatory activity and protest and civil unrest. The operating picture for Papua New Guinea this period looks to be deteriorating: the bulk of reporting concerns violent crime concentrated around Bougainville and Morobe. For business users, the principal business risk is direct exposure to violence and disruption at affected sites.

TOP 3 DEVELOPMENTS

Three shot dead, five injured, two on the run in Papua New Guinea prison escape - reports Homicide / violent crime · Reported 13 Jul 2026 · RNZ Pacific Heightened personal-security risk locally; review after-hours exposure and movement protocols.	HIGH
TWO SUSPECTS ARRESTED OVER DEATH OF A WOMAN Policing operation · Reported 16 Jul 2026 · EMTV (PNG) Localised disruption and checkpoints; short-term access constraints possible.	MODERATE
Twenty-seven locked-up from second ‘Sambio massacre’ arrest Homicide / violent crime · Morobe · Reported 15 Jul 2026 · Post-Courier (PNG) Heightened personal-security risk locally; review after-hours exposure and movement protocols.	EXTREME

INCIDENT DETAILS

CRIME, THEFT & ROBBERY

Crime, theft and violent incidents were reported, including violent crime and communal violence, reported across several areas without a single focus. The most serious reported was Does extreme rainfall trigger tribal violence in PNG? - Devpolicy Blog from the Development Policy Centre, assessed as High severity. Against the previous week the theme is rising. Business exposure centres on staff safety, premises, vehicles and the secure movement of cash and assets. Incidents of this kind threaten staff, premises and the movement of cash and assets.

Does extreme rainfall trigger tribal violence in PNG? - Devpolicy Blog from the Development Policy Centre Tribal / communal violence · Location not specified · Reported 16 Jul 2026 · Google News — Papua (Civil Unrest & Land Rights)	HIGH
DRIVER MURDER INVESTIGATION CONTINUES FOLLOWING FATAL BENA ROAD ACCIDENT Homicide / violent crime · Location not specified · Reported 15 Jul 2026 · EMTV (PNG)	HIGH
Three Killed in Baisu Prison Escape Homicide / violent crime · Location not specified · Reported 12 Jul 2026 · Post-Courier	HIGH
Kokopau Community Rallies Against Violence: Robust Awareness Initiative Transforms Local Wards Homicide / violent crime · Location not specified · Reported 15 Jul 2026 · Post-Courier (PNG)	LOW

Dilapidated infrastructure blamed for fatal PNG prison escape attempt

Homicide / violent crime · Location not specified · Reported 13 Jul 2026 · RNZ Pacific

LOW

GOVERNANCE & REGULATORY

Policing, regulatory and political-stability activity was reported, including community policing and corrections, concentrated in Bougainville. The most serious reported was Alcohol-Fueled Crime Hinders Progress: North Bougainville Women Demand Village-Level Community Policing, assessed as Low severity. Against the previous week the theme is easing. Business exposure centres on permits, compliance, checkpoints and freedom of movement. Regulatory, policing and political-stability friction can affect compliance, permits and freedom of movement.

Alcohol-Fueled Crime Hinders Progress: North Bougainville Women Demand Village-Level Community Policing

Community policing · Bougainville · Reported 15 Jul 2026 · Post-Courier (PNG)

LOW

3 dead while two still on the run in Baisu prison escape

Corrections / detention · Location not specified · Reported 13 Jul 2026 · NBC PNG

LOW

PROTEST & CIVIL UNREST

Protest activity and the crowd-control response to it were reported, including civil unrest, concentrated in Western and National Capital District. The most serious reported was ‘Leadership means stepping aside’: Pascoe Events founder declines WOW Awards Nomination to make space for rising leaders, assessed as Low severity. Against the previous week the theme is rising. Business exposure centres on road movement, site access and staff commuting near affected areas. Gatherings and the response to them can close roads and disrupt access at short notice.

‘Leadership means stepping aside’: Pascoe Events founder declines WOW Awards Nomination to make space for rising leaders

Civil unrest / protest · Location not specified · Reported 15 Jul 2026 · Post-Courier (PNG)

LOW

Peace Mediation Brings Southern Highlands and Nomad Communities Together in Kiunga

Civil unrest / protest · Western · Reported 14 Jul 2026 · Post-Courier

LOW

Public outcry over Hohola incident as viral video shows onlookers looting instead of helping

Civil unrest / protest · National Capital District · Reported 13 Jul 2026 · Google News — Papua New Guinea (Civil Unrest)

LOW

CURRENT SITUATION

The assessment centres on crime, theft and violent incidents, policing and regulatory activity and protest and civil unrest. The security picture in Papua New Guinea this period was dominated by violent crime, protest and civil unrest and natural hazards. Reporting clustered around Bougainville, Morobe and Western. The most serious entry reached Extreme severity.

The picture is operational rather than a single dramatic event: the priority for business users is movement security, premises protection and continuity at exposed sites while this picture holds.

OPERATIONAL IMPACT

Protest & civil unrest — Gatherings and crowd-control responses can close roads and disrupt access at short notice; build in transit buffers and keep routes flexible.

Crime, theft & robbery — Direct threat to staff, premises and the movement of cash or assets; harden security, vary routines and brief travellers.

Natural hazards — Weather and geological hazards can interrupt transport, utilities and site access; check conditions before movement and confirm site readiness.

Governance & regulatory — Regulatory, policing and political-stability friction can affect compliance, permits and freedom of movement; monitor official guidance.

Other operational disruption — Transport, utilities and connectivity disruption can interrupt operations and logistics; plan for contingencies and alternate routing.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

MOVEMENT SECURITY

Vary routes and timings, avoid predictable patterns, and confirm route status before travel.

Route around gatherings, rallies and choke points, and build in extra transit time.

Treat areas with confirmed violence as no-go for non-essential travel; use secure transport for any essential movement.

SITE SECURITY

Maintain premises protection: access control, guarding and after-hours security at exposed sites.

STAFF AWARENESS

Brief staff and travellers on current risks, local reporting lines and areas to avoid.

Remind staff to keep a low profile with cash, devices and valuables in public.

JOURNEY PLANNING

Confirm road, air and port status before travel and hold viable alternates.

Check weather and hazard conditions before movement and allow for delays.

ESCALATION TRIGGERS

Activate contingency and movement-restriction plans if higher-severity or casualty-bearing incidents reach or near operating sites.

LOCAL MONITORING

Track local reporting and official advisories for the locations on the watchlist, and reassess as fresh reporting comes through.

OUTLOOK: NEXT SEVEN DAYS

The coming week most likely follows the current pattern, led by violent crime, with protest and civil unrest also likely to recur. Key locations to watch: Bougainville and Morobe.

Escalation triggers: a spread of high-severity or casualty-bearing incidents beyond the locations above, and flashpoints around paydays, court rulings, election cycles and tribal-payback events.

Concern would ease with a sustained quiet stretch across Bougainville and Morobe, no further high-severity or casualty-bearing incidents, and no spread to new districts. Were the picture to deteriorate, expect direct disruption to movement and site access at the affected locations, with knock-on delays to staff travel and logistics.

ESCALATION INDICATORS

Larger or coordinated protest mobilisation, or labour action spreading to key sites and corridors

Further casualty-bearing or higher-severity violence at or near operating sites

Spread of incidents beyond Bougainville and Lae / Morobe into new districts

POLESTAR VIEW

Polestar assesses that operating risk in Papua New Guinea is deteriorating, driven by crime and violent incidents, protest and civil unrest and natural-hazard disruption. The main business exposure is staff safety, secure movement of cash and assets and staff movement. The most exposed areas are Bougainville, Lae / Morobe and Western. The most likely disruption over the next seven days is continued exposure to violent and opportunistic crime. The assessment would worsen if larger-scale incidents, casualty-bearing violence or sustained disruption emerge around paydays, court rulings, election cycles and tribal-payback events. For now, operators should tighten movement planning and site protection at the exposed locations and keep contingency arrangements under active review.

Operational Map

Reported operational issues this period



Direct impact Indirect impact Monitor only

● Lae Impact level: Monitor only What happened this period: Twenty-seven locked Business relevance: No reported commercial impact	● Western Highlands Impact level: Monitor only What happened this period: Three Killed in Baisu Prison Escape Business relevance: Local security awareness only	● Bougainville Impact level: Monitor only What happened this period: Alcohol-Fueled Crime Hinders Progress: North Bougainville Women Demand Village Business relevance: No reported commercial impact
● Southern Highlands Impact level: Monitor only What happened this period: Peace Mediation Brings Southern Highlands and Nomad Communities Together in Kiunga Business relevance: No reported commercial impact	● East New Britain Impact level: Monitor only What happened this period: ENB opens first permanent FODE centre since volcanic eruption Business relevance: No reported commercial impact	● Baisu Impact level: Monitor only What happened this period: 3 dead while two still on the run in Baisu prison escape Business relevance: No reported commercial impact
● Enga Impact level: Monitor only What happened this period: Police rescue elderly woman tortured over sorcery accusations in Enga Business relevance: No reported commercial impact		

Points show reported events at the town or province named in the reporting; where several share a location one marker carries the count. A marker is a town or province-level fix, not an exact point. 10 of 18 records name no specific place and are included in the totals and tables but not plotted.

Map Read

This map shows reported operationally relevant issues for the current reporting period. Not every security or crime incident creates commercial impact. Direct impact is used only where reporting shows a current or confirmed effect on operations, movement, access, site security, utilities, production, logistics, workforce

Impact is used only where reporting shows a current or confirmed effect on operations, movement, access, site security, utilities, production, logistics, workforce safety or business continuity. Indirect impact marks issues relevant to the operating environment with no confirmed effect on a client site, route, workforce, movement, production, access, utilities or logistics. Background incidents, preparedness meetings, isolated crime, political or legal developments, corruption investigations and general policing are Monitor only unless a clear operational effect is reported.

DISCLAIMER

Polestar Advisory Pte. Ltd. is an independent company registered in Singapore. The information in this report is based on open sources and is assessed as accurate at the time of writing. It is provided for general informational purposes only and does not constitute advice or a comprehensive assessment of all risks. No reliance should be placed on this information for operational decision-making without further independent verification.